

The Four Pillars in the Classroom

Identity, self-compassion, forgiveness, and grace — the ground every healthy classroom stands on.

PILLAR ONE

Identity

Who a student comes to believe they are — shaped by what we notice out loud.

TRY THIS IN CLASS: “STRENGTHS SPOTTING”

Each day, name one **true thing you saw a student be** — specific and out loud. Build an identity wall, not just a grade chart.

Say: *“I saw real persistence from you on that problem.”*

PILLAR TWO

Self-Compassion

How a student learns to speak to themselves under pressure.

TRY THIS IN CLASS: “COACH THE CRITIC”

Run a two-minute warm-up that **flips a harsh thought into a coach’s voice**. Post an Inner Coach anchor chart where they can see it.

“I’m so dumb.” → “Mistakes are how brains grow. What’s one thing to try next?”

PILLAR THREE

Forgiveness

Moving past mistakes to make room for growth — without shame.

TRY THIS IN CLASS: “REPAIR, NOT PUNISHMENT”

When something breaks down, walk the four steps: **own it · name the impact · make it right · reset**. Keep a calm repair corner.

Say: *“This is about making it right, not getting in trouble.”*

PILLAR FOUR

Grace

Meeting a student with understanding rather than only judgment.

TRY THIS IN CLASS: “CONNECTION BEFORE CORRECTION”

Greet them at the door, **regulate yourself first**, and assume the kinder story before you respond.

Remember: *“Your calm is the intervention. Everything else is secondary.”*